# The Praise of the Noble Lord Mañjuśrī in Ultimate Terms

Āryabhaṭṭārakamañjuśrīparamārthastuti · Toh 1131 · Derge Tengyur
འཕགས་པ་རྗེ་བཙུན་འཇམ་དཔལ་གྱི་དོན་དམ་པའི་བསྟོད་པ

This is The Praise of the Noble Lord Mañjuśrī in Ultimate Terms, known in Sanskrit as the Āryabhaṭṭārakamañjuśrīparamārthastuti and in Tibetan as Pakpa Jetsün Jampal gyi Döndampé Töpa. It is a brief hymn in verse, ascribed in its colophon to the great master Nāgārjuna, that praises the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī not through his appearance or deeds but from the standpoint of ultimate truth: he neither comes nor goes, is unborn, is neither entity nor nonentity, has no color, size, or measure, and abides neither in cyclic existence nor in nirvāṇa. Most stanzas close with a refrain of homage, and the hymn asks who could be praised, and by whom, when all phenomena are empty, before dedicating its merit so that the world may become like the buddhas. Closely resembling Nāgārjuna's Praise of the Ultimate, it is Toh 1131 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the Praises (stotra) section.

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In the language of India: ārya bhaṭvāraka mañjuśrī paramaartha stuti nāma. In the language of Tibet: The Praise of the Noble Lord Mañjuśrī in Ultimate Terms.

Homage to Mañjuśrī in youthful form.

You have not come, nor do you go;
You have not risen, nor do you abide;
You utterly transcend the worldly;
Your sphere lies beyond words.

O Protector, how can I praise you?
Nevertheless, relying on the designations of the world,
Just as you are,
With devotion I praise you, O Master.

Unborn by essential nature,
You have no birth whatsoever.
O Protector, you have no going and no coming:
To you, free of entity, I bow in praise.

You are neither entity nor nonentity,
Not annihilated, nor everlasting;
You are not permanent, nor impermanent:
To you, the nondual, I bow in praise.

You are not red, not green, not crimson,
Not yellow, not white, and not black;
You have no color whatsoever:
To you, free of color, I bow in praise.

You are not large, nor small,
You are not coarse, nor subtle;
You are not of the element of long and short:
To you, the immeasurable, I bow in praise.

Through knowledge, you do not abide in existence;
Through compassion, you do not abide in peace;
You abide neither in nirvāṇa nor in saṃsāra:
To you, the nonabiding, I bow in praise.

You do not abide in any phenomena,
Yet you have fully realized all phenomena;
You rest upon supreme profundity itself:
To you, the profound, I bow in praise.

If you are praised like this, it counts as praise;
Otherwise, how could you be praised?
When all phenomena are empty,
Who is praised, and by whom?

Without extremes and without a middle,
Having wholly abandoned the grasped and the grasper,
To you, free of concepts, I bow in praise.

Through the merit of this true and ultimate
Proclamation of the name of the Master, the Protector Mañjughoṣa,
May this world
Become like the Sugatas (the buddhas).

The Praise of the Noble Lord Mañjuśrī in Ultimate Terms, composed by the great master Nāgārjuna, is complete.

## Translator's Notes

• This hymn closely parallels Nāgārjuna's Praise of the Ultimate (Paramārthastava), here addressed to Mañjuśrī; it is translated as it stands. The seventh stanza expresses the nonabiding nirvāṇa: wisdom keeps the awakened one from remaining in cyclic existence, and compassion keeps him from resting in solitary peace.

## Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.